

HTML5 Elements & Attributes Quick Reference Guide

Bootcamp Training Resource for Absolute Beginners

❑ **Important Clarification for Beginners: The align/text-align Misconception**

Historically, legacy HTML allowed an 'align' attribute directly on the <p> tag (e.g., <p align="center">). However, this is completely deprecated in modern HTML5. Properties like alignment, font colors, and font families belong exclusively to CSS via the 'text-align' property. In modern markup, you should teach students to use classes or standard stylesheets to manipulate text orientation rather than inline structural properties.

1. Global Attributes

Global attributes are standard properties that are acceptable and valid across all HTML5 structural elements:

- **"id"**: A completely unique page-level identifier used to anchor target links or hook individual elements via JavaScript.
- **"class"**: A reusable descriptor group identifier used to target and apply cohesive style properties across multiple elements via custom styles or Bootstrap frameworks.
- **"style"**: Enables writing direct, inline CSS presentation adjustments directly inside the structural tag (highly discouraged for production but valuable for real-time validation learning).
- **"title"**: Appends structural descriptive metadata that displays an accessible visual tooltip popup when a user hovers over the element.

2. Common Elements & Acceptable Attributes Reference Table

Category	Element Tag	Description / Structural Purpose	Acceptable / Specific Attributes
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Category	Element Tag	Description / Structural Purpose	Acceptable / Specific Attributes
Structure	<html>	The root layout element wrapper container wrapping all document properties.	lang (e.g., lang="en")
Structure	<head>	Houses critical page metadata, title metrics, and asset hooks entirely invisible to layout views.	Global attributes only
Structure	<body>	Houses all semantic layout content elements presented directly to visual view users.	Global attributes only
Text Layout	<h1> to <h6>	Document structural section headings arranged hierarchically (h1 = main, h6 = minor).	Global attributes only
Text Layout	<p>	Constructs a standard, structural paragraph text segment element block.	Global attributes only
Text Layout		An generic structural layout inline text element used to isolate text segments safely.	Global attributes only
Media / Links	<a>	Creates absolute/relative hyperlinks targeting anchor destinations, external URLs, or resources.	href, target (e.g., target="_blank"), download
Media / Links		Embeds dynamic graphic raster or vector assets directly onto page boundaries (Self-closing).	src, alt (essential asset description), width, height
Lists		Constructs an unordered structural collection list (presents standard circular bullet items).	Global attributes only
Lists		Constructs an ordered structural sequence list tracking incremental counter items.	type (e.g., '1', 'A', 'a', 'I'), start, reversed
Lists		Declares an internal list row item component wrapped inside structural ul/ol parent blocks.	value (only valid inside an container)

Category	Element Tag	Description / Structural Purpose	Acceptable / Specific Attributes
Containers	<div>	A completely generic layout block wrapper component optimized for custom CSS/Bootstrap rules.	Global attributes only
Containers	<header>	Semantic block containing navigational titles, intro segments, or platform logos.	Global attributes only
Containers	<nav>	Isolates a group of critical structural menu routing paths and hyperlink bars.	Global attributes only
Containers	<section>	Defines a generic independent layout section segment mapping related elements.	Global attributes only
Containers	<footer>	Semantic layout block capping documents containing legal indices, copyrights, or footers.	Global attributes only
Forms	<form>	Configures an interactive processing block designed to collect, house, and route field data.	action (target execution URL), method (GET or POST)
Forms	<input>	Self-closing interactive data capture field accepting varied information types.	type (e.g., text, email, password, submit), name, value, placeholder, required, disabled
Forms	<textarea>	Multi-line freeform plain text wrapper field optimized for capturing extensive body remarks.	name, rows, cols, placeholder, required, disabled
Forms	<label>	Declares text descriptions contextually paired directly to explicit interface inputs.	for (must match the targeted field 'id' attribute)
Forms	<button>	Generates an actionable interface control execution element with built-in cursor trigger support.	type (submit, button, reset), disabled, name, value